Start: letters a m s t · lesson 3 of 8 · 50 minutes

Meet /s/: sun and sock

Today your child learns: I can say /s/ for the letter s, clap the parts in a word, and write small a.



Standards: RF.K.2b, RF.K.2, RF.K.1d, RF.K.3a, RF.K.3b, RF.K.1a, RF.K.1b, RF.K.1c, RF.K.1, L.K.1a, 10.5 K.A, 10.5 K.B, 10.5 K.C. Common Core State Standards © 2010 NGA Center and CCSSO.

10′ Sounds · 3′ Letters · 20′ New · 7′ Read · 10′ Write

Today at a glance

10 min	Sound games: clap the parts in sun, apple, astronaut and names.
3 min	Letter drill: a and m, small and capital, name, sound, picture.
20 min	New letter s: say /s/, trace S and s, circle /s/ pictures.
7 min	Reading together: the child points under each word as you read.
10 min	Handwriting: circles, small a, then the first name.

Get ready (2 minutes)

- Print: Meet the Letter s
- Print: Which Start with /s/?
- Print: Handwriting: a and My Name, day 3
- From the kit: letter cards a, m, s and A, M, S
- Big book Hello, School! (from day 1); pencil, crayon, highlighter

Printing in black and white? The green start dot is the big dot.

Tip for the grown-up

Keep /s/ smooth and long, like air from a tire: sss, never suh. Praise the exact thing: You held /s/ so smooth!



Short on time? At home in 20 minutes

1. Clap word parts together for 3 minutes: sun, apple, astronaut, then your child's name.
2. Show the a and m cards for 2 minutes: name, sound, key picture, small and capital.
3. Spend 7 minutes on Meet the Letter s and Which Start with /s/?: hiss sss, trace S and s, circle the /s/ pictures.
4. Read Hello, School! for 3 minutes while your child taps under each word.
5. Finish with 5 minutes on the handwriting page: circles, small a, then the name you wrote in highlighter.



SOUND GAMES

Sound games: clap the parts

10 min

Hear and clap the syllables (parts) in spoken words. No letters.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

Words have parts. I clap each part. Sun. One clap.

Ap-ple. Two claps.

As-tro-naut. Three claps.

- Clap each part slowly, hands apart between parts.
- Hold up one finger for each clap to show the count.

We do together

SAY

Clap with me: mit-ten. How many claps? Two!

Map. One clap. To-ma-to. Three claps!

Now stomp it: sand-wich. Stomp, stomp. Two!

- Clap together, then count the fingers together.
- Switch to stomps on the last word to get the wiggles out.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn. Clap it and tell me how many: sock.

Now: salad. Now: Saturday.

Last one: your own name. Clap it!

- Say each whole word once. Do not split it for the child.
- The child claps alone and shows the count with fingers.

If your child gets it wrong

- My turn: sa-lad, two claps. Our turn: sa-lad. Your turn: salad?
- If claps blur, slow down: one part, one clap, hands apart between parts.



LETTER DRILL

Letter drill: a and m

3 min

Say the name, sound and key picture for a and m, small and capital.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

Letter a. /a/, like apple.

Letter m. /m/, mmm, like map.

Capital M card. Same sound: /m/.

- Hold up the small a card, then hold up the capital A card. Do the same with m.
- Keep /m/ humming with lips closed. No uh at the end.

We do together

SAY

Together: letter a, /a/, apple.

Letter m, /m/, map.

Capital A card, /a/. Capital M card, /m/.

- Point and say it together, crisp and quick.
- Mouth wide for /a/, lips closed for /m/.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn. I point, you say the name, the sound and the picture.

- Mix A, a, M, m. Point slow, then faster; the child answers alone.
- Keep the s card aside. It joins the mix at the end of today's lesson.

If your child gets it wrong

- If the child says muh: My turn: mmm, no uh. Our turn. Your turn.
- If the name is missed: That's the letter m. Say it with me. Return in two cards.

NEW SKILL

New letter s: /s/ like sun

20 min

Link the letter s to /s/ (a long, smooth hiss) and hear /s/ at the start of words.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

This is the letter s. It says /s/: sss. Sun starts with /s/.

Capital S: Start just below the top line. Curve back, then curve forward, like a snake.

Small s: Start just below the middle line. Curve back, then curve forward, like a snake.

- On Meet the Letter s, point to the sun. Snake your arm while holding sss.
- Finger-trace big S from the green dot, then small s, saying the path.

We do together

SAY

Snake arm with me: sss. Hold it long. No uh.

Say the path in the box with me. Sock, seal, six: /s/!

Sock. Does sock start with /s/? Yes! Circle it. Hat? No.

- Trace S and s together from the green dots; name sock, seal and six.
- On Which Start with /s/?, do sock and hat together, stretching each first sound.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn. Say each picture. Circle it if it starts with /s/.

Now my mixed cards: a, m, s. Tell me the sound and the picture.

- The child names and circles seal, fan, duck, six alone. Check with the answer key.
- Add the s card to a and m. Mix, point; the child says sound, then picture.

Letter paths: say these words as you write

S Start just below the top line. Curve back, then curve forward, like a snake.

s Start just below the middle line. Curve back, then curve forward, like a snake.

If your child gets it wrong

- If the child says suh: My turn: sss, smooth, no uh. Our turn. Your turn.
- If fan is circled: Listen: fff-an. /f/, not /s/. Our turn. Now you: six?

READING TOGETHER

Reading together: one word, one touch

7 min

Point under each word as the grown-up reads (the child reads no words yet).

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

Watch my finger. One word, one touch.

Hello, School! Two words, two touches.

My finger jumps over the spaces.

- Read the title of Hello, School! slowly, touching under each word.
- Read page 1 the same way, sweeping back to the start of the next line.

We do together

SAY

Put your hand on mine. We touch each word together.

Ready? Touch, read. Touch, read.

- Read 3 pages slowly with the child's hand riding on yours.
- Pause a beat on each word so the touch and the word land together.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn to be the pointer. I read, you touch.

Did your finger and my voice finish together?

- Read the next pages slowly; the child taps under each word alone.
- Finish the book with expression and enjoy it together.

If your child gets it wrong

- If the finger races or skips: Stop. My turn: one word, one touch. Our turn. Your turn.
- If the child taps pictures: Words are the black marks. Touch here.

HANDWRITING

Handwriting: circles, a and my name

10 min

Sit tall with a pinch-and-flip grip; form circles and small a; trace and write the first name.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

Pinch and flip. Sit tall. Watch me make small a.

Start just below the middle line. Circle back all the way around.

Push up to the middle line and pull straight down.

- On the circle row, start at the green dot and circle back all the way around.
- Write one big small a on the a row, saying the path as you go.

We do together

SAY

Air-write with me, big: Start just below the middle line. Circle back all the way around.

Push up to the middle line and pull straight down. Say it with me.

Now we trace the first circle and the first a together.

- Air-write two big a letters together, saying the path out loud.
- Trace the first circle and first small a together, your hand lightly over the child's.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn. Trace 3 circles, then make one alone from the green dot.

Now trace 3 small a letters and write one alone. Say the path.

Last, trace your name. Capital first, then small letters.

- Write the child's first name in highlighter on the name row, capital first.
- The child traces the name, then writes it alone underneath.

Letter paths: say these words as you write

a Start just below the middle line. Circle back all the way around. Push up to the middle line and pull straight down.

If your child gets it wrong

- If the a starts at the top or circles forward: Stop. My turn. Our turn. Your turn.
- If the grip slips: Pinch and flip again. Sit tall, feet flat.

Quick check (2 minutes)

1. Hold up the s card and ask, What sound? (a long, smooth /s/ with no uh).
2. Say sit and map, and ask which one starts with /s/ (sit).
3. Say sunflower; the child claps the parts and says how many (3).

Got it

All 3: tomorrow, run day 4 as written; s joins the daily letter drill.

Nearly

2 of 3: tomorrow, start the drill with the s card and sun, and add one extra clap word to sound games.

Not yet

0 or 1: tomorrow, add 2 minutes first (in class a small group; at home just you and your child): a, m, s cards with apple, map, sun, plus 3 clap words, My turn, Our turn, Your turn.